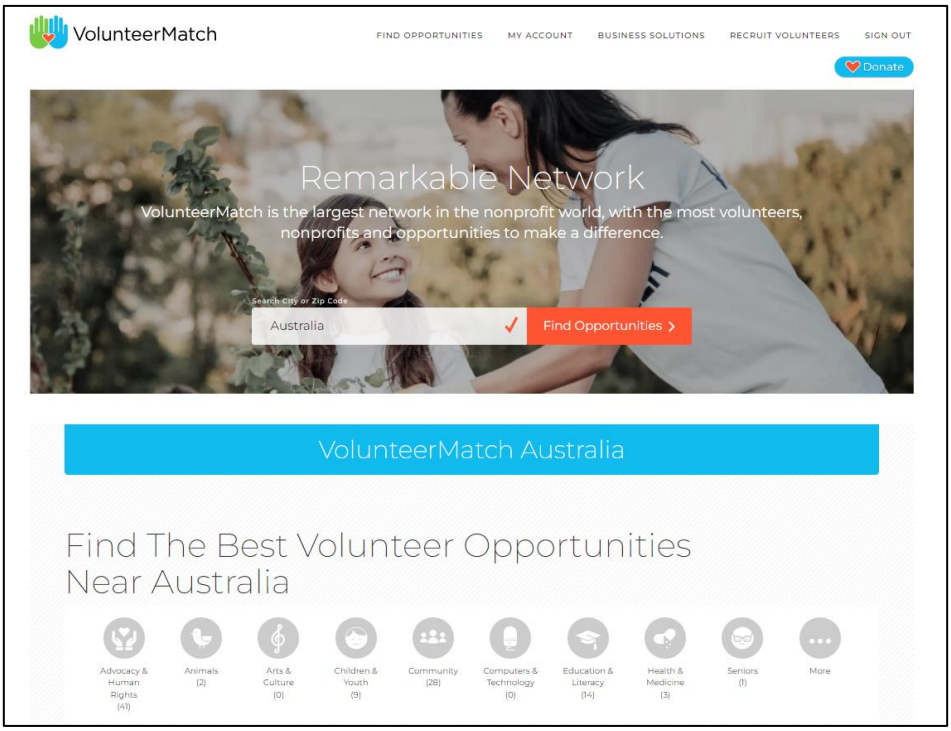
Research

<u>For home page:</u>

Volunteer Match: https://www.volunteermatch.org/



- **What work too well:**

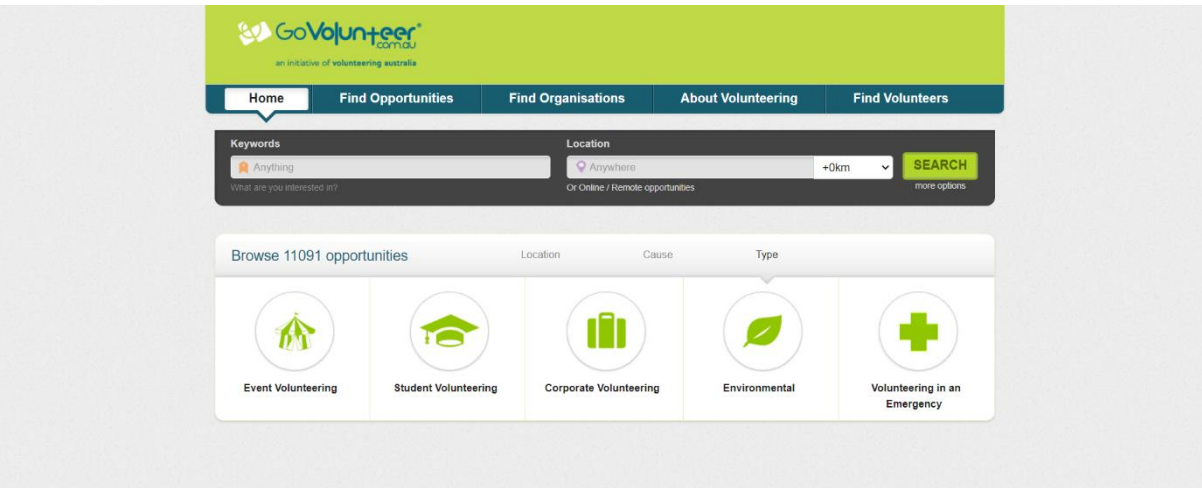
The look of the VolunteerMatch sign-up page is modern and appealing to the eye. The hero image makes the space feel warm and welcoming, and it makes the VolunteerMatch mission clear. The search bar is placed in the hero section in a way that makes it easy for users to start looking for opportunities right away. The "Find Opportunities" button stands out and makes people want to interact with the site. The volunteer opportunities listed below the "hero" section are clearly organised into groups that make it easy for users to find what they're looking for. Using icons for categories adds a visual element that makes the site more interesting for users.

- **What doesn't work too well:**

The hero section looks good, but it takes up a lot of screen space, which could mean that important content is pushed below the fold. It would be easier to use the search bar if there were clearer instructions or examples of what people can type in it. You could make the "Find Opportunities" button stand out more by making it bigger or changing its colour to one that is more different from the others. There are too many links in the navigation bar. Rearranging or removing some of them would make it easier to use. Real-time validation for the search bar would also improve the user experience by giving them feedback right away.

By putting the search bar and call-to-action button in a prominent place, the design effectively reduces kinematic load by cutting down on the need for excessive scrolling or navigation. One more thing that could be done to make things better is to make the navigation bar easier to understand and use. Clear labels and easy-to-understand icons make it easy to use, but real-time feedback and more noticeable call-to-action buttons would make it even better. In terms of heuristics, the design follows the rules of simplicity, consistency, and good looks. However, it could use better error prevention and feedback systems, especially in the search function.

GoVolunteer: https://govolunteer.com.au/



- **What works well:**

The homepage of GoVolunteer is a great example of a clean, simple design that puts user ease of access first. The GoVolunteer logo and the main navigation tabs, such as "Find Opportunities," "Find Organisations," "About Volunteering," and "Find Volunteers," are in the header at the top of the page. These tabs are lined up logically and are easy to find, which makes navigation simple for users and reduces the amount of kinematic load.

The central search function is placed in a way that makes it easy for users to enter keywords and location information. The search bar's location at the top of the page makes it the first interactive element that users see, which is important for a platform that helps volunteers find opportunities. The extra feature of being able to narrow searches by distance or online/remote opportunities makes it even easier to use and accommodates different user preferences. The site has an easy-to-use list of volunteer opportunities broken down by type, such as Event Volunteering, Student Volunteering, Corporate Volunteering, Environmental Volunteering, and Volunteering in an Emergency. These groups are shown visually by icons, which help users quickly find the things they're interested in. Using icons and a clean layout reduces kinematic load, making it easy for users to quickly figure out what options are available and get to them.

- **What doesn't work too well:**

There are some things that we think could be done better on the GoVolunteer homepage, but overall it works very well. Even though the design is clean, the site would be more welcoming with more interesting images involved in it. Volunteer activities could also be made more emotional and encourage people to get involved by using high-quality photos or short video clips. This particular website is very straight to the point, but perhaps too much in our opinion.

Also, even though the navigation bar works, it could use a more clear sign for the "Home" tab. At the moment, the logo acts as the home button, which some users may not notice right away. Adding a separate "Home" tab could make things easier on the brain by making it clear how to get back to the home page. There's also the use of whitespace and content spacing. The layout is clean, but there is a big space between the navigation bar and the main content area. This gap could be narrowed to put more content above the fold. This would make it easier to get to more information without having to scroll. Also, the search function is central and easy to find, but it lacks advanced filtering options that would make the experience better for users. Users could narrow their searches more precisely if there were more advanced filters, like filters based on date or specific skills needed. This would make search results more relevant.

Style/Structure: The page is concise, centered on finding volunteer activities, and provides information on finding opportunities, finding organizations, and popular science related to volunteering. The logo is in the upper left corner of the page, and below it is the title bar. The keyword and location search bar provides the fastest, simplest and most direct search function. The lower part of the page provides a list of opportunities divided into three modules by location, reason, and type. There are also quick links at the bottom of the page.

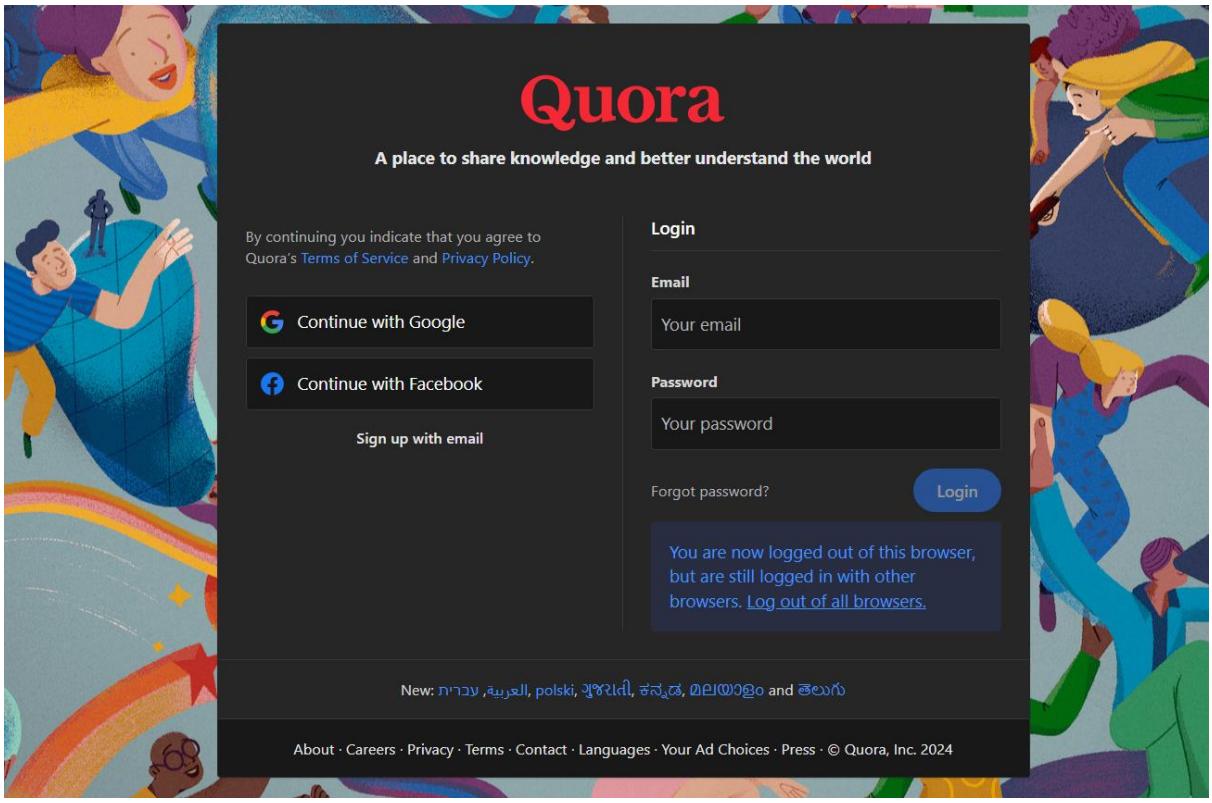
Features:

1. Quickly find volunteer opportunities based on location and keywords.
2. Accurately target opportunities suitable for users according to filters such as categories and time.
3. Search for volunteer organizations by keyword and location.
4. Provide volunteering guides and links to volunteering centers.
5. Browse volunteer services by location, cause and type.

User interaction: Clicking on the logo icon will navigate directly to the home page. Navigate to listing pages for internal volunteer opportunities and organizations using the click-find search feature. Navigate directly to the corresponding page by clicking on the link.

Log in page.

Quora:
https://www.quora.com/?time=1715765557709706&uid=1029843539&unh=e36befea87b290401499df28a56b17c7



- **What works well:**

Quora's login/signup page is a great example of combining useful design with eye-catching functionality. The page looks good because it has a colourful and interesting background that draws attention to the main parts of the page without taking away from them.

On the right side of the page, the login form is easy to see and has fields for users email address and password. Users can be sure they know what information is needed by using placeholder text in the fields. The "Forgot password?" link is placed right below the password field so that users who have forgotten their credentials can quickly get them back. Here we can login to Quora in a number of ways, such as by using Google or Facebook. These social sign-in buttons are clearly labelled and come with well-known logos. Users can log in with their existing social media accounts, which saves them time and effort. This feature makes it easier to log in, which makes it faster and more convenient.

The buttons that tell users what to do, like "Continue with Google" and "Login," are meant to stand out by having a clear visual hierarchy. The buttons are big enough to click without much trouble, which is especially helpful for people who use touch screens. The login button is easy to

find because it is a different colour from the rest of the page. A short message about agreeing to Quora's privacy and terms of service is also part of the design. It is placed right above the login buttons. This placement makes sure that users understand the terms without getting in the way, which keeps the user experience smooth.

- **What doesn't work too well:**

The sign-up button is not as noticeable as the login button. A clearer sign-up button or link could be added to make the experience better for new users. We can clearly see that the "Sign up with email" is below the social sign-in options, so new users may not notice it right away. Adding a short description or benefits summary next to the sign-up form is another thing. Drawing attention to the best things about joining Quora could encourage more people to sign up.

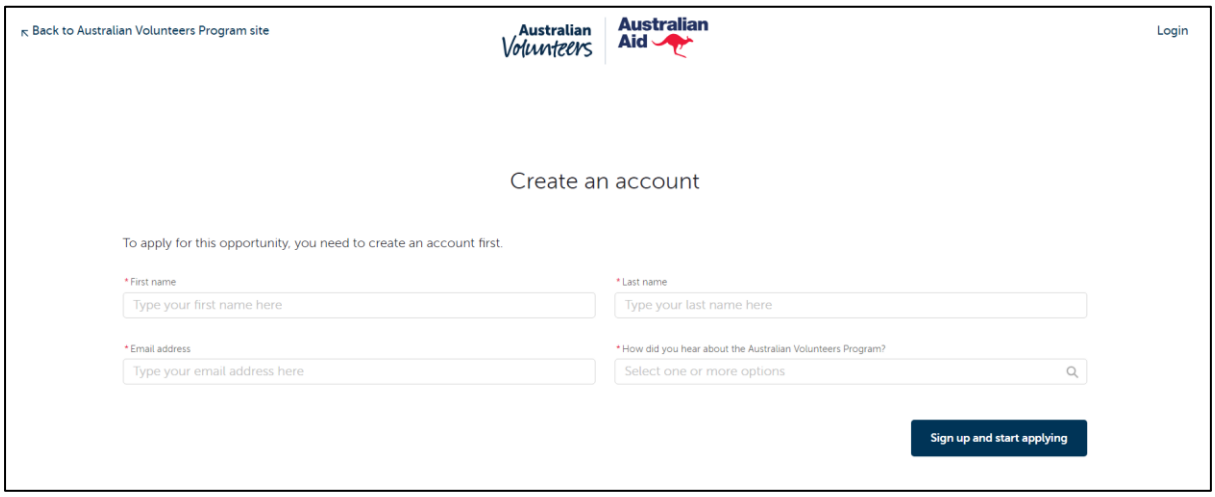
Additionally, the illustrated background is visually appealing, but it could be too much for some users. For people who like simpler designs, giving them a choice of a simpler background or a toggle to make the illustration smaller could help them focus. Lastly, it's very important to make sure that all of the elements are accessible. This includes giving screen readers alternative text and making sure that users who are blind or have low vision can see clearly enough.

- **Technical:**

From a technical point of view, the layout of the login page keeps kinematic load low by putting all the interactive parts close to each other. Users can quickly and easily switch between input fields and buttons without having to move their hands or mice around a lot. When we consider responsive design, the page will look good on all screen sizes, so users can enjoy the same experience on their computer, tablet, or phone.

Sign up page.

Australian Volunteers: https://www.australianvolunteers.com/



- **What works well:**

The design is simple and clean, which keeps users focused on the main task at hand, which is creating an account. The input fields are clearly labelled and come with placeholders that make it easy to see what information is needed. The two-column layout of the input fields makes good use of space and makes sure that entering data goes in a logical order. This button, which says "Sign up and start applying," is placed in a way that makes it stand out and encourages people to fill out the form. Including a "Back to Australian Volunteers Programme site" link and a "Login" option also makes it easy for users to do other useful things, giving them more control and freedom.

- **What doesn't work too well:**

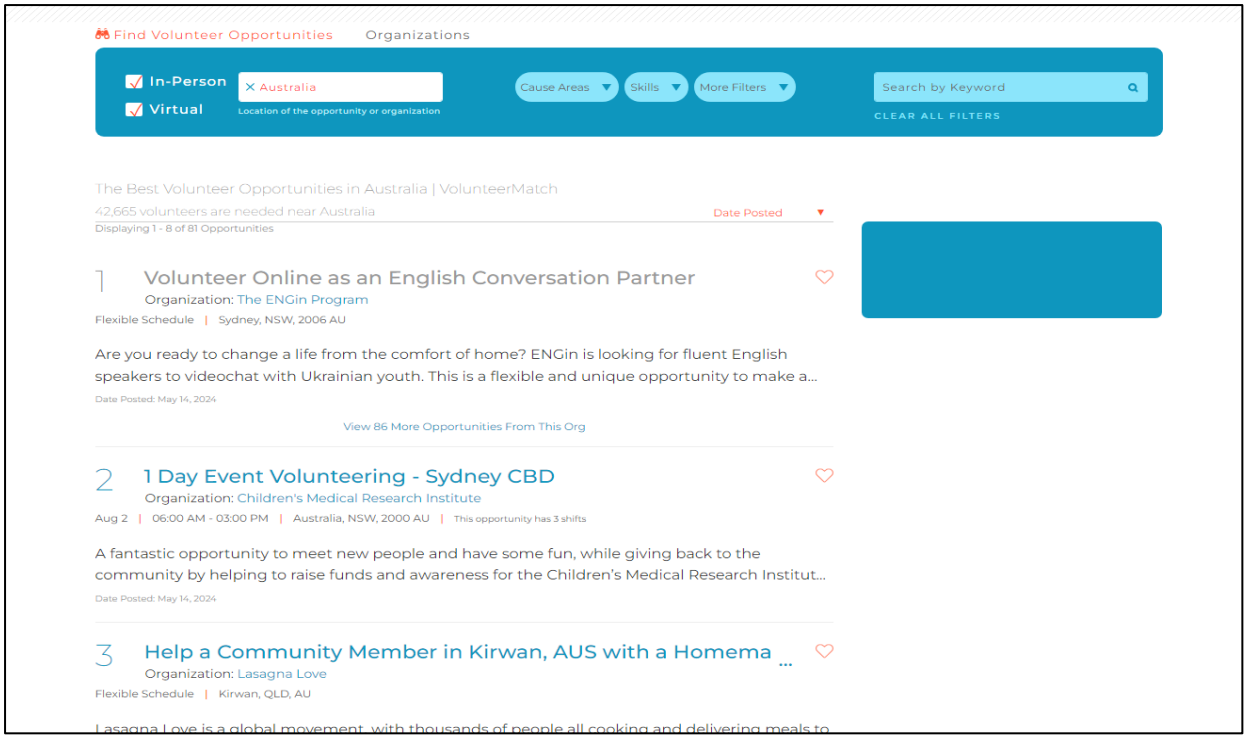
Even though it has some good points, it could use some work. The text that says "To apply for this opportunity, you need to create an account first" should stand out more so that all users can see it. The space between the input fields could be made bigger to make it easier to read and lower the chance of making mistakes. The "Back to Australian Volunteers Programme site" link could be better integrated into the design so that it doesn't look like a link to a different page. Adding real-time validation to the input fields would also improve the user experience by letting them know right away if there are any errors or missing information. This way, users wouldn't have to go back and fix their mistakes after sending in the form.

Kinematic load is kept to a minimum by grouping fields that are related and making an easy way for them to interact. Autofill for common fields and validation in real time would make the process even easier. Clear labels and instructions make it easy to use, but inline error messages and more space would make it even better. The form is simple and consistent, but it would be better if it had real-time validation and auto-fill to help stop and fix mistakes.

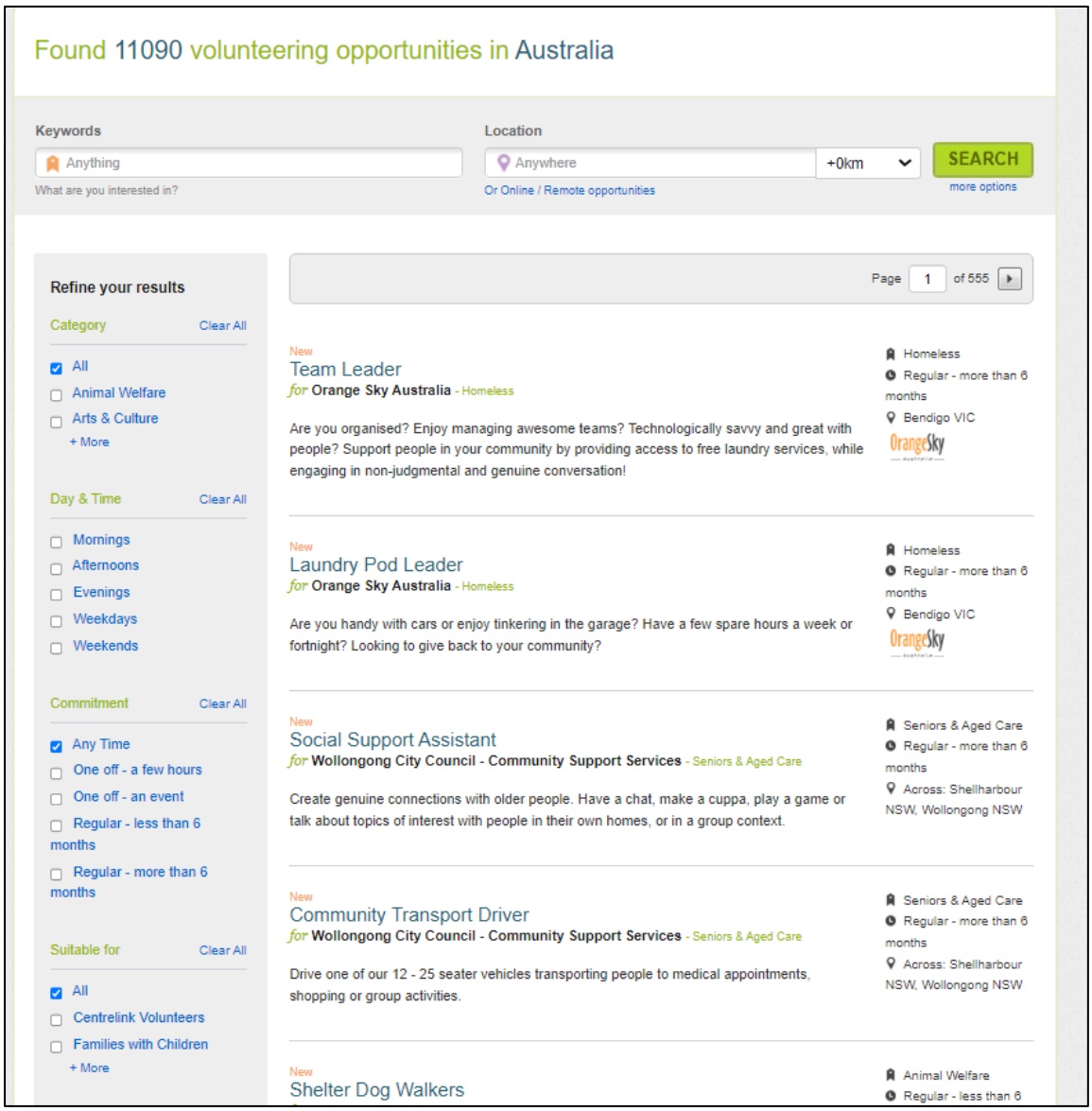
Volunteers Page (organization page for our project)

Here, still using the same examples of the two websites, which in our project will be changed to list of organizations page instead of volunteers page. But they effectively serve the same purpose.

VolunteerMatch: https://www.volunteermatch.org/search?l=Australia&v=true



GoVolunteer: https://govolunteer.com.au/volunteering



We'll perform a comparison of the volunteers/opportunities page and take away the goods and bads from each example.

There are a lot of filtering options on the left side of the GoVolunteer page, which is one of its best features. With these filters, users can narrow their search by "Animal Welfare," "Arts & Culture," "Day & Time," "Commitment," and "Suitable for." This ability to filter in a lot of different ways is very helpful for people who are looking for opportunities that exactly match their preferences and availability. Each volunteer opportunity is clearly laid out with a title, the name of the organisation, and a short description. This makes it easy to scan. Visual cues, such as icons for opportunity types and locations, make the user experience better by giving them information quickly. The page itself, on the other hand, doesn't look very good. It has an old-fashioned interface that could use some modern design elements to make it more interesting. The presentation's heavy use of

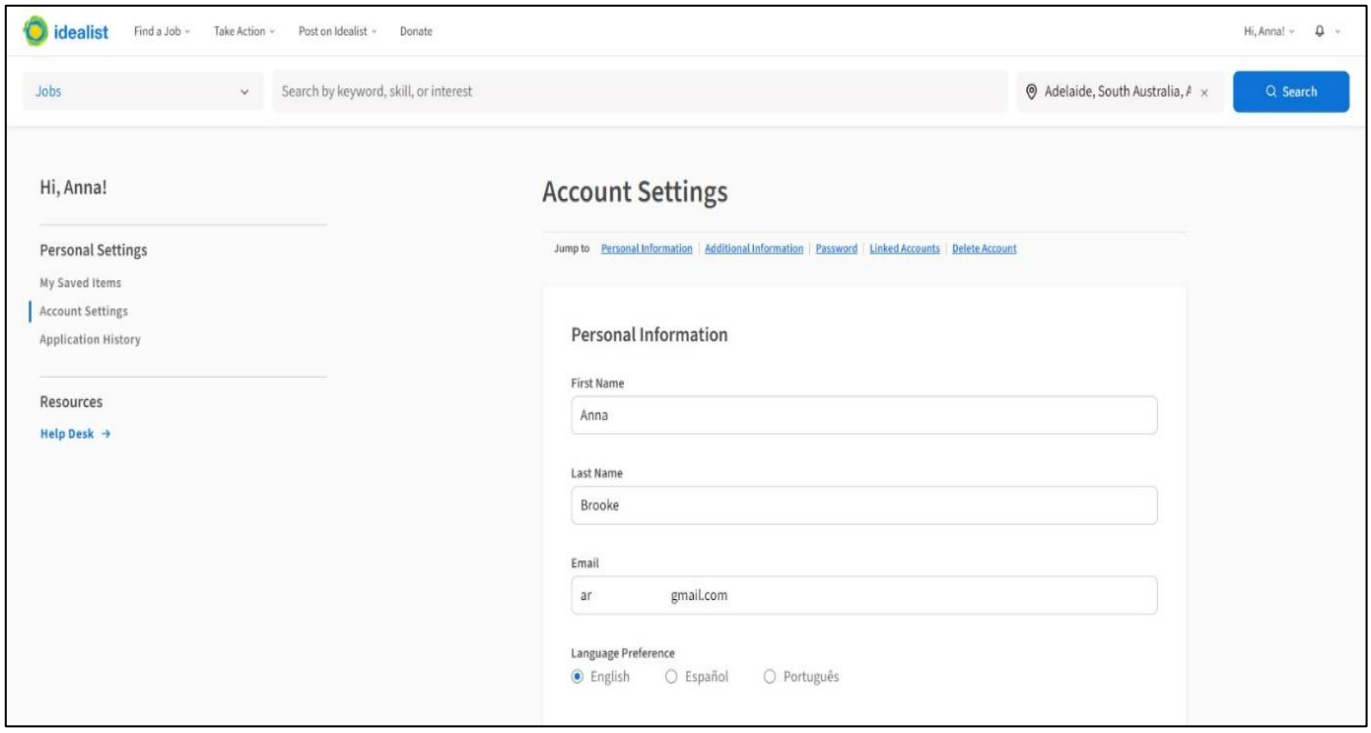
text can be overwhelming. Adding more whitespace and visual elements could make it easier to read and keep people interested.

On the other hand, VolunteerMatch has a modern, clean look that is both nice to look at and easy to use. A welcoming atmosphere is created by using white space, a consistent colour scheme, and a simple layout. There are expandable listings for each volunteer opportunity, so users can see more information without leaving the main page. This approach, along with responsive design that makes sure it works on all devices, makes VolunteerMatch very easy to use and interesting. Using icons and color-coded tags for different types of opportunities and levels of commitment makes it look better and make it easier to use. However, the filter is placed at the top and has to be navigated to by first clicking, and then displaying a pop-up. Although a clean design, this has more kinematic load when compared to GoVolunteer which filters are all present on the left side of the page.

VolunteerMatch stands out because of its modern, easy-to-use design and dynamic content presentation, making it both easy to use and visually interesting. GoVolunteer has powerful filtering options that help users find the right opportunities, but it could use some improvements to look better and be easier to use. Both platforms have their good points. VolunteerMatch is better at design and getting users involved, while GoVolunteer is better at functionality through advanced and much easier filtering.

Personal Account Overview

Idealist: https://www.idealist.org/dashboard/account-settings



- **What works well:**

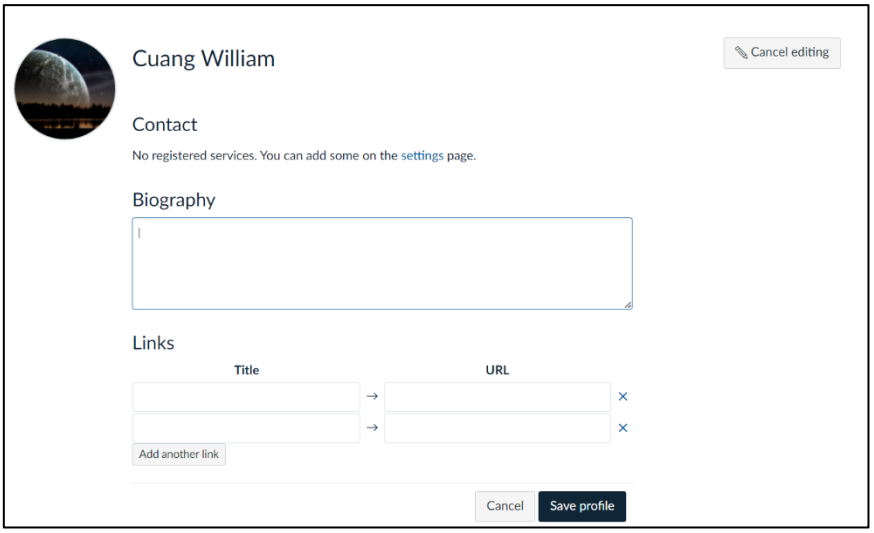
The clean and simple layout stands out right away, and it's easy to find your way around. A lot of white space keeps things simple, so people can focus on the most important information on the page. The sections are clearly separated, and the main content that pertains to personal information is displayed in a way that makes it easy for users to find and change their information. The "Jump to" links for Personal Information, Additional Information, Password, Linked Accounts, and Delete Account, among others, make it easy to find what you're looking for quickly, saving users time and effort. The design stays consistent with the rest of the site, making it easy to use by creating a familiar space. Also, accessibility features like language preference options are easy to use, so they can be used by a wide range of people.

- **What doesn't work too well:**

There are, however, some things about the page that could be better. The current design doesn't have any interactive features, like tooltips or inline help, that could help people fill out the form fields correctly. Using different font sizes or weights for headings and subheadings could also improve the visual hierarchy and make the structure of the information stand out more. One big problem is that form inputs don't get real-time feedback, so users don't get immediate validation messages when they enter wrong information. This can make people angry and cause mistakes, which takes away from the overall user experience.

In terms of kinematic load, the page's simple design means that it doesn't require much work to interact with. However, adding features like auto-complete or suggestions for email input fields could make things even easier for users. Keeping sections close together in the current layout reduces the amount of mouse movement needed, but adding dropdowns or sections that can be collapsed could make navigation even faster. As far as usability goes, the page is simple and easy to understand, with clear labels. It's easy for users to find where to enter their information. The design gives users freedom and control, making options like deleting their account easy to find. The page supports recognition rather than recall, and all of the fields and options are shown clearly, which makes it easier for users to think.

Uni Adelaide: https://myuni.adelaide.edu.au/profile



- **What works well:**

The personal profile editing page's clean and simple layout makes it easier to use and keeps users interested. There is a profile picture and name right at the top, which makes it more personal and gives the editing process more context. Users can work on one part of their profile at a time because the Contact, Biography, and Links sections are clearly separated. The "Cancel editing" button in the upper right corner and the "Cancel" and "Save profile" buttons at the bottom give users control over what they do, which is in line with usability guidelines that stress user freedom and control. The form fields and buttons are also placed well, making things easier by keeping related fields close to each other and giving clear, easy-to-click options.

- **What doesn't work too well:**

But there are some things that could be better about the page. At the moment, the "Contact" section says, "No registered services" and sends users to the settings page to add them. This can get in the way of their work and add to the kinematic load by making them navigate more. Adding the ability to add contact services right to this page could make the process go more quickly. There is no placeholder text in the form fields where you can add links, which could help users know what information is expected. The "Add another link" button is in the right place, but it would be easier to find if it had a visual cue, like a plus sign. Adding real-time validation to the biography and links fields could also stop mistakes and give users immediate feedback, making the experience better.

In terms of kinematic load, the current design makes it easier to do things by grouping fields that are related and making buttons easy to see. But adding auto-save could cut down on the number of clicks even more, making the experience better for the user. The page is generally

easy to use because it has clear labels and a logical layout that encourages recognition over recall and lowers cognitive load. Real-time validation and more detailed input field instructions could be used to help stop mistakes and give better instructions.

The page also does a great job of being aesthetically pleasing and minimalist, avoiding extraneous elements and focusing on the task at hand. Web design patterns that are already known help keep things consistent and up to code. However, inline validation and more detailed instructions in the form fields could help stop errors even more. The page would be even easier to use if it had real-time validation, better visual hierarchy, and contact service management built into the page where you edit your profile.